

Special Results: Blinded, Knocked Down, Immobilized or Stunned

Characters in combat are normally assumed to be able to see and move with relative freedom. If this is not true, then they suffer specific penalties. Characters can use various combat maneuvers to produce such states in their opponents.

Blinded: If a character is completely blind or fighting in complete or almost complete darkness, the she cannot perform any ranged attacks or defensive maneuvers, and the difficulty of all of her other physical actions increase by +2.

Knocked Down: If an attack or other circumstance causes a character to fall down, he must take one action to scramble back to his feet. If for some reason he can't, he's counted as partially immobilized until he regains his feet.

Immobilized: If a character is restrained, paralyzed, or otherwise unable to move freely, any character who attacks him reduces her difficulty by -2 if the target is still able to move a little bit. If the target cannot move at all, then all attacks automatically hit.

Stunned: If — after the soak roll — a character suffers a number of health levels of damage from a single attack that equals or exceeds her Stamina, she's stunned until the end of the following turn. Stunned characters can't perform any actions except attempting to shake off the effects of the blow. Attack rolls against stunned characters reduce their difficulty by 2.

attacks by firearms. Using a shield to parry or provide armor against an attack requires a successful parry maneuver, but when used to provide armor against a firearms attack, the parry roll isn't resisted — the character just attempts to place the shield between her and the bullets.

The downside to shields is much like that of armor: They are large, obvious, and heavy. Even more than armor, people on the street are going to look at you very oddly if you walk around with a large shield on your arm. For more on both armor and shields, see the Armor chart and Shields chart, under Combat System Charts (p. 285).

Swashbuckling Kithain can also use cloaks or long coats as shields. The changeling cannot be wearing this garment to use it as a shield and must instead hold it in one hand and parry with it. Using a cloak or long coat in this fashion gives the wielder all of the benefits of a shield. However, a blow or two with a weapon will ruin this garment.

Combat Summary Chart

Stage One: Initiative

- First, roll initiative. Next, everyone declares their actions in order from lowest to highest initiative. The character with the highest initiative performs her action first. Actions can be delayed to any time later in the order of initiative.
- Declare any multiple actions, reducing dice pools accordingly. Characters must also declare any cantrip use or Willpower expenditure.

Stage Two: Attack

- For unarmed close-combat attacks, roll Dexterity + Brawl.
- For armed close-combat attacks, roll Dexterity + Melee.
- For ranged combat, roll Dexterity + Firearms (for guns, bows, or crossbows) or Dexterity + Athletics (for all thrown weapons).

Stage Three: Defense

- Characters can either combine a defense with another action as part of a multiple action or they can perform a desperate defense and only defend. When using desperate defense, defending against multiple attacks subtracts 1 die from the defense pool after defending against each attack.
- A character can abort her planned action to a defensive action (block, dodge, parry) at any time before her action is performed, as long as the player makes a successful Willpower roll versus difficulty 6 or spends a Willpower point.

Stage Four: Resolution & Damage

- Determine total damage effect (based on the weapon type or maneuver), adding any extra dice gained from successes on the attack roll.
- Targets may attempt to soak damage, if possible. Kithain, like mortals, cannot soak lethal damage unless they are wearing armor, except when this lethal damage is chimerical. Kithain can soak chimerical lethal damage just like bashing damage. Each success on the character's soak roll reduces their damage taken by one health level.